The man, who was a skilled elephant driver, covered the elephant's back with a sort of saddle-cloth, and attached to each of its sides some uncomfortable **howdahs**. Phileas Fogg paid the elephant owner with some banknotes which he extracted from the famous **carpet-bag**, an action that made poor Passepartout lose his breath.

While Sir Francis and Mr. Fogg took the howdahs on either side, Passepartout got onto the saddle-cloth between them. The driver **perched** himself on the elephant's neck, and at nine o'clock they set out from the village, the animal marching off through the dense forest of palms by the short cuts.

Jules Verne

Discuss and answer.

1. Which mode of transport did Fogg choose?
2. Did he hire Kiouni? Why?
3. Why was the elephant owner happy with the deal?

GLOSSARY

TI26A

hesitation	-	unwillingness
conveyance		transportation
rapidly	-	quickly
persisted	-	continued
refused	-	not willing
point-blank	-	bluntly
flurried	-	worried
yielded	-	accepted
howdahs	-	a seat for riding on the back of an elephant
carpet-bag	-	a travelling bag made of the thick woven fabric used for carpet
perched	-	positioned

7th Std English_Term 3.indd 85 26-10-2022 15:38:14